

Project Retrospective – Building Documentation Management System SoSe 2025

What Went Well

- Agile practices were implemented successfully, and the team gained a strong understanding of the Scrum process.
- Scrum rituals improved communication and helped establish a productive workflow.
- Coordination within the team, especially between Scrum Master, Product Owner, and developers, worked very well towards the end of the project.
- The stakeholder was described as extremely helpful and kind, contributing positively to the work environment.
- Despite challenges such as a server issue during the demo, the team handled the situation professionally and effectively.
- Team members showed noticeable growth in both technical skills and collaboration.
- Everyone gained valuable experience and knowledge, contributing to a successful project outcome.

What Could Have Gone Better

- Some guest lectures were not well received. The AI-related lecture in particular lacked scientific substance and felt more like marketing than education.
- Task distribution was uneven at times, with some members taking on a disproportionate amount of work for the same credit.
- Differing experience levels or personal circumstances were not always sufficiently considered in sprint planning.
- Communication breakdowns led to smaller achievements and blocked progress during some weeks.
- Pull request approvals were inconsistent and sometimes slow, creating bottlenecks.
- Misunderstandings occasionally escalated into arguments, showing a need for better coordination.
- The current grading based on commits lacks transparency, making it unclear how commits should be structured or submitted to positively impact the grade.

Suggestions for the Future

- Replace email standups with mandatory short daily meetings to improve real-time communication.
- Provide clearer grading-guidelines for commit evaluation to improve transparency and align expectations.
- Establish a clear process for handling impediments during sprints to avoid unnecessary delays.
- Introduce a technical mentor or tech lead role to support technical direction and reduce recurring issues.
- Align team formation not only by tech stack but also by personal interests to improve motivation and cohesion.
- Implement regular check-ins to ensure alignment and prevent miscommunication.
- Define a more consistent and transparent process for pull request approvals.
- Encourage more frequent voice or video calls to resolve misunderstandings more quickly.